

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1087

By Lowe

A RESOLUTION to honor Dewey V. Woody, Jr., on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a gentleman who has devoted his life to public service in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Dewey V. Woody, Jr., is taking a well-deserved retirement from the State of Tennessee, having devoted more than four decades to safeguarding the lives and property of his fellow citizens through service in fire protection, law enforcement, emergency management, arson investigation, and homeland security; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Woody worked as a deputy with the Bradley County Sheriff's Office before joining the Cleveland Police Department, where he spent fourteen years in various roles; and

WHEREAS, demonstrating exceptional skill and dedication, Dewey Woody continued his public safety work with the Bradley County Sheriff's Office as a reserve deputy and lead fire investigator from 2000 to 2012; and

WHEREAS, as a member of Bradley County Fire and Rescue Department from 2000 to 2012, he held the position of fire chief, leading ten stations, fifty-seven full-time firefighters, and ninety volunteers while strengthening countywide fire protection and emergency response capabilities; and

WHEREAS, Chief Woody transformed the volunteer force into one of the best professional fire and rescue squads in the State; and

WHEREAS, when Bradley County experienced devastating tornados in 2011, Chief Woody coordinated a rescue response that established the blueprint for such emergencies, and his professionalism and efficiency during this crisis became legendary among his peers; and

WHEREAS, Dewey Woody joined Tennessee State Government in 2012, first as Director of the Bomb and Arson Section of the Department of Commerce and Insurance and subsequently as Chief Operating Officer and Deputy Director of the Tennessee Emergency Management Agency, where he helped guide statewide preparedness, coordination, and emergency response; and

WHEREAS, since 2016, he has served with the Tennessee Department of Safety and Homeland Security as a Special Agent, bringing to the position a depth of experience matched only by his steadfast commitment to the mission of protecting Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, a devoted husband and family man, Dewey Woody is most grateful for the love and support of his wife, Melissa Alley Woody, and his three daughters; and

WHEREAS, as he enters retirement, Mr. Woody will take with him more than four decades of accumulated knowledge, skill, and experience, leaving a legacy of excellence that will be remembered and appreciated by those who have had the privilege to serve alongside him; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Dewey V. Woody, Jr., for making Bradley County and the State of Tennessee safer for their citizens during his forty-plus years of public service and extend to him our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.